

Law Firms: Why Hire a Third-Party Mediator?

Law firms often face complex disputes that can be costly, time-consuming, and damaging to client relationships if handled through traditional litigation. Hiring a third-party mediator offers several advantages:

- **Client Satisfaction:** The desire to preserve personal and professional relationships is a significant factor affecting many disputes. Mediation preserves client relationships and reputations by fostering collaborative solutions; reduces the time from complaint to resolution by empowering the parties to negotiate agreements.
- **Lowens the cost of conflict:** Mediation reduces legal fees, court costs, and the amount of stress a person experiences in litigation by giving them control of the outcomes and providing a transparent, affirming environment to work through grievances.
- **Risk Management:** Mediation helps manage litigation risks by providing a controlled, less adversarial environment. and the ability to explore tailored solutions that courts may not provide.
- **Enduring Agreements build Trust:** An impartial mediator facilitates balanced dialogue and fair outcomes in a way that allows the opposing party to find solutions rather than contest their claims.

Core Competencies

- **Trauma-Informed Mediation:** Specialized in resolving disputes with empathy, dignity, and emotional intelligence.
- **Prelitigation Conflict Resolution:** Affordable, professional alternatives to litigation for families, workplaces, and communities.
- **Narrative-Based Dialogue:** Techniques that honor lived experience and foster durable, values-aligned outcomes.

Turning conflicts into opportunities

- **Army LDRSHIP Values:** Loyalty, Duty, Respect, Selfless Service, Honor, Integrity, Personal Courage — infused into every engagement.
 - **Legal Authority + Human Insight:** Magna Cum Laude law graduate with deep procedural knowledge and a mission to re-humanize conflict resolution.
 - **Community-Rooted:** Active in Baltimore and statewide, with strong ties to therapists, clergy, attorneys, and veteran organizations.
 - **Affordable & Accessible:** Positioned as the “nearly legal” alternative — professional, principled, and within reach.
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Past Performance

- **General Counsel, U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs** Represented the Agency in more than 700 high-stakes employment and settlement negotiations, supporting executive-level decision-making and agency representation.
 - **Equal Justice Grant Recipient** Provided free legal services to veterans in Maryland criminal courts, advocating for dignity and second chances.
 - **Founder, Professional Mediations LLC** Built a private practice focused on principled, relationship-preserving mediation for underserved communities.
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Company Data

- **Business Name:** Professional Mediations LLC
- **Owner:** Christian Piatt, Esq.
- **Location:** Essex, MD | Serving Baltimore and statewide
- **Certifications:** Maryland Bar in 2017, Nat’l Assoc. Cert. Mediators, 2025.
- **NAICS Codes:** 541199 (All Other Legal Services), 624190 (Other Individual and Family Services)